

JINGYI WU

Research Interests: Language and Vision; Event Cognition; Natural Language Processing

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EDUCATION

2024–2026	University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	Visiting Scholar in Communication
2021–2026	Zhejiang University	Ph.D. Candidate in Linguistics
2017–2021	Dalian Maritime University	B.A. in English

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2024–2026	Researcher, Visual Intelligence Lab, UCLA
2022–2023	Research Assistant, Artificial Intelligence and Computing Center, Zhejiang Lab

PUBLICATIONS

Wu, J., Xu, E., Bitterman, E.B., Tenenbaum, J.B., Hartshorne, J.K., Gao, T. (2026). Is Language a Window into the Human Mind? The Same Latent Features Guide Categorization in Language and Vision. Manuscript under review at *Proc. 48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*

Xu, E., **Wu, J.**, Tang, N., Hartshorne, J.K., Tenenbaum, J.B., Gao, T. (2026). Verb Semantic Reasoning: a Semantics-Guided Approach for Improving Action Understanding in Vision–Language Models. Manuscript under review at *Proc. 48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*

Wu, J., Fu, S., Dale, R., Gao, T., Liang, J. (2025). Beyond Emotion: Unraveling the Limited Role of Sentiment in Extended-Format Communication. *Proc. 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Wu, J., Liang, J. (2025). When or What? Understanding Consumer Engagement on Digital Platforms. arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.10474.

Wu, J., Zhang, T., Liang, J. (2025). Can Professional Norms Reshape Gendered Discourse? Understanding Linguistic Accommodation in Science and Literature. Manuscript under second-round review at *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.

Wu, J., Liu, Y., Liang, J. (2025). Visible Voices: Investigating the Consistency of Translator’s style. Manuscript under second-round review at *Sage Open*.

Papers in Preparation

Wu, J., Gao, T. Computational Modeling of Cooperative Communication with a Physics-Based RSA Framework.

Wu, J., Fu, S., Liang, J. From Topics to Traction: Predicting Content Popularity Through Textual Structure.

Wu, J., Liang, J., Fu, S. The Dynamics of Meaning: How Semantic Progression Shapes Audience Engagement.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Wu, J., Xu, E., Bitterman, E.B., Hartshorne, J.K., Gao, T. Grounding Verbs in Intuitive Physics: Few-Shot Categorization of Action Events. Poster to be presented at the *39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*, Boston, MA, March 2026.

Wu, J., Hartshorne, J.K., Gao, T. Grounding Verbs in Intuitive Physics: Few-Shot Categorization of Action Events. Talk presented at the *California Meeting on Psycholinguistics*, Davis, CA, November 2025.

Wu, J., Fu, S., Dale, R., Gao, T., Liang, J. Beyond Emotion: Unraveling the Limited Role of Sentiment in Extended-Format Communication. Poster presented at the *Annal Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, San Francisco, CA, July 2025.

Wu, J., Liang, J. Can Professional Norms Reshape Gendered Discourse? Understanding Linguistic Accommodation in Science and Literature. Talk presented at the *International Conference of Psycholinguistics in China*, Dalian, China, May 2024.

Luo, C., **Wu, J.**, Zhang, J. Second Language Proficiency Modulates Neural Tracking of Acoustic and Linguistic Rhythm. Poster presented at the *National Conference on Research and Application on EEG and Neuroimage*, Lanzhou, China, April 2023.

Wu, J., Zhu, C., Liang, J. Syntactic Structures Differences across Interpreted and Oral Texts. Talk presented at the *National Conference and International Forum on Interpreting*, Wuhan, China, November 2022.

Wu, J., Liang, J. Translator's View: A Mirror of Translator's Subjectivity in Chinese Literature. Talk given at the *Graduate Students Forum on Language and Literature Studies*, Hangzhou, China, October 2022.

INVITED TALKS

Is Language a Window into the Human Mind? Evidence from Linguistic and Visual Categorization

Language & Cognition Research Seminar, Harvard University 2026

Visual Intelligence Lab, UCLA 2025

Coalas Lab, UCLA 2025

Beyond Emotion: Unraveling the Limited Role of Sentiment in Extended-Format Communication

Coalas Lab, UCLA 2024

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2024 – *Studying Abroad Scholarship (\$20,000)*

Zhejiang University

2022 - 2024 – *Academic Merit Award (¥8,000/yr)*

Zhejiang University

2021 – *Outstanding Graduate Award*

Dalian Maritime University

2021 – *Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis*

Dalian Maritime University

2020 – *China National Scholarship (¥8,000)*

Ministry of Education, China

2020 – *Top Ten Outstanding Students*

Dalian Maritime University

2020 – *President's Scholarship (¥10,000)*

Dalian Maritime University

2018 - 2019 – *Academic Merit Award* (¥8,000/yr)

Dalian Maritime University

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistantship		
2022 Fall	Understanding Publication and Presentation Seminar	Zhejiang University
2021 Fall	English for Academic Purposes	Zhejiang University
Independent Teaching		
2023 Fall	College English Listening and Speaking	Zhejiang University of Finance and Economics

MENTORSHIP

2025	Ella Bitterman	Psychology	Northeastern University
2025	Vikas Sundar	Statistics	UCLA
2025	Elena Yu	Cognitive Science	UCLA
2025	Elle Birkenruth	Communication	UCLA
2024	Tianyi Zhang	Linguistics	Zhejiang University

REFERENCES

Junying Liang, Professor	Zhejiang University	jyleung@zju.edu.cn
Tao Gao, Associate Professor	UCLA	taogao@ucla.edu